

Chosanta Limited

Risk Assessment Policy for the Care of Young Persons

Version 1.0 | May 2026

1. Policy Statement & Organisational Commitment

Chosanta Limited is committed to keeping all young persons (under 18 years) safe from harm while availing of our services. As a provider of relevant services under the Children First Act 2015, we will undertake a thorough risk assessment of any potential for harm, implement robust procedures, and ensure compliance with TUSLA guidance, HIQA standards, and the Joint TUSLA/An Garda Síochána Protocol. This policy applies to all residential care, foster support, emergency placements, aftercare, and related services.

2. Legal & Regulatory Framework

- Children First Act 2015 (Section 11)
- Children First: National Guidance 2017
- TUSLA CSSCU-GDE01.1 Guidance on Risk of Harm Assessment (5-step process)
- HIQA National Standards for Children's Residential Centres 2018
- Joint TUSLA/An Garda Síochána Missing Persons Protocol
- GDPR and Child Care Acts 1991-2013

3. 5-Step Risk Assessment Process

Step 1: Understand the Context - Who, What, Where, How services are delivered.

Step 2: Identify Potential Risks - Missing from care, exploitation, abuse, online safety, self-harm, environmental hazards, etc.

Step 3: Examine & Rank Risks - Use 5x5 Likelihood x Impact Matrix.

Step 4: Plan Mitigation & Controls.

Step 5: Monitor, Review & Communicate - Annual reviews and post-incident.

4. Risk Register (Examples)

Risk: Missing from care | Likelihood: High | Impact: Severe | Controls: Joint Protocol with Garda, Absence Management Plans

5. Mandatory Procedures

Safe recruitment, training, reporting allegations, complaints, code of conduct, supervision.

6. Appendices & Contacts

Full templates, TUSLA links: tusla.ie